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**AN ARABIC APOCRYPHON
OF SAINT STEPHEN THE ARCHDEACON**

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FOREWORD

Among the papers left by the late Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ there was found his English translation of the Arabic Version of the Apocryphon of Saint Stephen the Protomartyr. The Coptic (Ṣa'îdic) Version of this Apocryphon was edited by Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ in *Le Muséon*, vol. LXX, pp. 329-347. We felt that scholars would be interested to possess also the text of the Arabic Version of this Apocryphon, and, therefore, in memory of the late Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ we have prepared a critical edition of the Arabic text to which we have joined his English translation.

The Arabic text from which Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ made his translation is that found in *MS. 15 Hist.* of the Library of the Church of the All-Holy Virgin Mary known as the *Kasriyat ar-Riḥân* in *Kasr aš-Šam'* in Old Cairo, where it is found on foll. 234^ro-249^vo. The Arabic text of this *MS.* we have prepared for publication, revising at the same time the English translation of Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ.

In addition to the abovementioned *Ms.* the text of the Arabic Version of this Apocryphon is also found in two other *MSS.*, a) A *MS.* preserved in the Library of the Church of Saint Barbara in the *Kasr aš-Šam'*, b) A *MS.* preserved in the Library of the Church of the All-Holy Virgin Mary in the *Ḥarat Zuwailah*, Cairo. We have collated the text from which Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ made his translation, with that of the *Ḥarat Zuwaila MS.*, and we have recorded all variant readings of importance in the foot-notes of both the Arabic text and the English translation. Though, in general, the text of the *Ḥarat Zuwailah MS.* agrees with that of the *Kasriyat ar-Riḥân MS.* there are, as will be seen, some marked differences.

In conclusion, we would like to add our thanks to those expressed by the late Yassâ 'Abd al-Masîḥ to Dr. O. H. E. KHS-Burmester for his kind assistance in the preparation of this article.

ANTOINE KHATER

DESCRIPTION OF THE MSS.

- 1) MS. 15 Hist. Library of the Church of the All-Holy Virgin Mary, known as Kašriyat ar-Rihân, in the Kašr aš-Šam' at Old Cairo. The text of the Apocryphon is found on foll. 234r^o-249v^o. This MS. is dated the 10th Abib, 1540 A. M.=1824 A. D. Sigillum A.
- 2) Ms. 2 Hist. Library of the Church of the All-Holy Virgin Mary in the Hârat Zuwailah, Cairo. The text of the Apocryphon is found on foll. 25r^o-34r^o. This MS. is dated 1450 A. M.=1733-34 A. D. Sigillum B.
- 3) MS. 12 Hist. Library of the Church of Saint Barbara in the Kašr aš-Šam' at Old Cairo⁽¹⁾. The text of the Apocryphon is found on foll. 198v^o-211v^o. This MS. is dated the 23rd Amšîr, 1453 A. M.=1737 A. D.

ORTHOGRAPHICAL CHARACTERISTICS OF MS. A⁽²⁾

- a) The following letters are for the most part without the diacritical points (ت) - (ث) - (ج) - (خ) - (ذ) - (ى) .
- b) The ث is always written as ت, ex. الثالث for الثالث .
- c) In many cases ت is used in place of the final ة, ex. سيرت for سيرة .
- d) The final . (hamzah) at the end of words is usually omitted, الاتا for الاتا .
- e) The final unattached ى of words is always written with two diacritical points beneath it, ex. المساوي - الذي .

⁽¹⁾ For a description of these churches, cf. O.H.E. KHS-BURMESTER, *Guide to the Ancient Coptic Churches of Cairo*, Cairo, 1955, pp. 36-39, 68-73, 31-34.

⁽²⁾ See Plates 1 and 2.

TEXT

* ٢٣٤
 بسم الاب والابن والروح القدس الاله الواحد . نبتدى بعون الله تعالى وحسن توفيقه بشرح سيرت القديس الجليل والانا المكرم المختار اول الشهدا وراس الشمامسة الرسول العظيم استافانوس تلميذ ربنا والاهنا ومخلصنا يسوع المسيح له المجد الذي اكمل جهاده في اليوم الاول من شهر طوبه^(١) المبارك بركاته وصلواته معنا امين . المجد لله القديم الازلي الاول الغير مبتدي ، والابن الخالق الذاتي والروح القدس الحى المساوي التالوت الكامل والاله الواحد بلا افتراق ولا امتزاج ولا اختلاط الغير مربي الغير محتوي الذي هو فوق الفوق وتحت التحت الذى له سلطان السما والارض بلا زوال ، العالم بالكون . قبل كونه الذي لا يخلوا منه مكان ولا يسعه مكان ولا تحصره العيون ولا تفضحه الظنون مالك الممالك كلها شا بارادته وروح قدسه في اخر الازمان ونزل من السما وتجسد من مريم العذري الطاهره سيدة اولاد ادم وولد بيت لحم اليهوديه وصنع اعمال البشريه ما خلا الخطيه ، واعتمد من يوحنا نسيه في نهر الاردن ووضع لنا المعمودية وصلب وقبر وقام من بين الاموات واصطفوا الرسل التلاميذ واختارهم وطهرهم ولما كان بعد صعوده الى السموات وجلس في حضن ابيه المكان الذى لم يخلوا منه قط طرفه عين وارسل لهم روح القدس المعزي فنطقوا بساير اللغات وايدهم بالايات والمعجزات والقوات التي تعجز عن عملها البشريين . المخلوقين وارسلهم يكرزوا في العالم باسمه العظيم فن آمن واعتمد خلص^(٢) وبعد صعوده المقدس الى اعلا السموات^(٣) عادوا الرسل من الجبل المدعوا جبل الزيتون^(٤) ومضوا الى العالم يبشروا الناس ويدعوهم الى الايمان بالتالوت المقدس الاله الواحد وكان في يروشلیم انسانا

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « في الخامس عشر من شهر توت » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : لا يحتوى على الجزء من « المجد لله القديم الازلي » حتى « ... خلص » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف « وجلس عن يمين ابيه » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يذكر « وابتدوا التلاميذ أن يكرزوا في اورشليم وجمع كبير سمعوا الامانة » .

والقتل والفسق والفرقة والهزل والنميمة والعداوة والحسد والايمن الكاذبة والسكر والمزاح والشره ومحبت النصيب الاكثر هولاء بالحقيقة كلهم يغضبوا الاله وفيما القديس استافانوس يتكلم بهذا الكلام مع الجماعة اتوا اليه بانسانا^(١) به استسقا دخلوا به الى المكان ووضعوه تحت رجله وسالوه من اجله اما هو لما رأى امانتهم رشم فواد^(٢) ذلك الانسان واذنيه قايلًا يشفيك ربنا يسوع المسيح الذي اتا ليحيي الخطاه وامر ان يبشر باسمه في العالم وفي تلك الساعة عوفى^(٣) ذلك الرجل من مرضه فلما رأى^(٤) ريس الجماعة ذلك آمن هو واهل بيته واناس كثير وتعمدوا وخلصوا من خطاياهم وكانوا الرسل والجماعة ينموا ويكرزوا باسم ربنا والاهنا ومخلصنا يسوع المسيح وكان عدد التلاميذ يكثر بايروشلیم ونعمة الله زائدة جدا في جماعة المؤمنين وكان القديس استافانوس يعلم الناس بكلام ربنا يسوع المسيح ولما كان في بعض الايام اتا اليه ساحرين من مدينة افسس وغلطيه احدهم اسمه يواس والاخر ارسطاديموس^(٥) وهذا قال للقديس استافانوس اريد اعلم هذا الايات التي تصنعهم باسم من من الاله^(٦) فاجابه القديس استافانوس قايلًا هولاء من قبل الاله السما والارض والبحار والانهار وكل المخلوقات السيد يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحي الازلي الذي اتا تلميذه ومبشرا باسمه في كل العالم وهو الاله ورب الارباب وفيما القديس استافانوس يتكلم بهذا اتوا اليه جمع كثير واذا انسان ابرص تقدم اليه قايلًا اسالك أيها الرسول القديس الكريم استافانوس ان تضع يدك على لابرا من مرضي وان القديس استافانوس لما رأى انه له ايمان ليخلص وضع يده عليه وقال له باسم ربنا يسوع المسيح تظهر من مرضك ورشمه بعلامت المقدس

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « بانسان به شيطان استسقا مجبول » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يذكر « رشم بطن ذلك الانسان » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يذكر « انشق بطنه وافخذه وخرج منه مادة كثيرة وعوفى » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يذكر « اخو لسيوس رئيس الجماعة » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : يذكر « الواحد منهم من افسس اتا الى اورشليم واسمه ارسطاديموس والآخر من غلطايا متجه الى اورشليم اسمه يواس » .

(٦) مخطوط ب : يضيف « بهرمس أو باصيدون أو با ارميس الذي لا يناس » .

اسمه سمعان ابن زكا زوجته تدعا حنه وكانا^(١) الاثنان انسانان خايفين من الله وبارين اتقيا يرجوا عزا اسراييل بغير لوم امام الله حافظين نواميسه وكان هذا سمعان له ولدين احدهم يدعا يهوذا والاخر يدعا استافانوس وكان وديعا بارا تقيا حافظا الكتب الله المقدسه . وانه مضى والتصق بالرسل وكان يدخل^{* ٢٣٥} ويخرج معهم ويخدمهم بنشاط لانه كان صالحا عفيفا وديعا متضعا وديعا بارا تقيا حافظ الكتب ونعمة الرب عليه وروح قدسه لابسا له كالتوب وكان كلامه كالسيف الحاد تجادل اليهود والوثنيين^(٢) والحنفا والامم الغريبة^(٣) ويردهم الى الايمان بسيدنا يسوع المسيح له المجد^(٤) فلما كان في تلك الايام اجتمع جمع كبير الى الرسل من ساير الكور المحيطة بهم وكل المدن والسكان^(٥) بين النهرين والقضاء والعرب والقبادوقيه وبنطس واسيه وافريقيه وبنفليه ونواحي لوتيه هولاء كلهم يجتمعوا لتعليم الرسل الاطهار وكان القديس استافانوس يصنع ايات كثيرة وقوات في . الشعب باسم ربنا والاهنا ومخلصنا يسوع^{* ٢٣٦} المسيح ويخرج الارواح النجسه ويدع يده على المرضى فيعافوا وكان وجهه يضي بنعمة روح القدس مثل الملائكة الاطهار واذا كان نطق حسن لان روح القدس كان ينطق على فيه وكانت الرسل تحبونه جدا لان كل من كان يساله عن شيء فيجيبه عاجلا بكلام حاد كالسيف اذ كان يتكلم بروح القدس وادب صالح ويعلم الجمع الدخول الى معرفت الله والايمان المستقيم فلما كان ذات يوم وهو جالس يعلم الشعب ليحيدوا عن الشرور هكذا قايلًا ان كل من هو في بشرى المسيح ابن الله الازلي وهو تحت ستر الجماعة . التي اقتناها^{* ٢٣٦} السيد المسيح بدمه يجب عليه ان يترك عنه الاعمال النجسه التي هي الزنا والدنس

(١) مخطوط ب : الصيغة المستعملة خاصة بانسان مفرد وتعود الأوصاف لسمعان .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يذكر « العشارين » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « الامم الغريبة » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يضيف « ويطرد الكفر من جنس البشر » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : يذكر « وهم من بنطس ونيميطة والسكان في الجزيرة الوسطا وافريقيه وبنفليه ومصر ونواحي لوتيه . اليهود والغربا . القضاء والعرب » .

يا اخوه وآمنوا بربنا يسوع المسيح تروا مجد لاهوته وقام للوقت وصلى هكذا قايلًا يا سيدي يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى مخلص نفسى وجسدى اسمعنى انا عبدك الخاطى لكيلا يفسد تعبى ويصير كلا شىء وليلا يقول هذا المنافق ان ليس إله لنا ويهلك نفوس المؤمنين بك ايها الرب ضابط الكل اعط عبدك قوة وثبات امام هذا المجمع لانك الرب الرؤوف الملك الحقيقى لك المجد الى الابد امين فلما قال . القديس استافانوس هذا الكلام جتا على ركبته وخرّ ساجدا لله بوجهه على الارض وبغته صار اضطراب عظيم فى الجلو وخوف كثير^(١) واذا ملاك الرب صاح بقوة وصرخ بصوت عظيم من السما قايلًا ليؤخذ المنافق ليلا يرى مجد الله^(٢) وضرب ملاك الله الشياطين الحاملين كرسى ذلك المنافق فتركوه ونزلوا من علو السما الى اسفل الارض وصار قطعاً ومات اشرموته وان المجمع رفعوا اصواتهم قايلين ليس الاله الا يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى الذي يكرز باسمه فى العالم وامن بربنا يسوع المسيح فى تلك الساعة ثلاث الف نفس فاما^(٣) ارسطاديموس لما رأى ما كان امن بربنا يسوع المسيح وسجد . للقديس استافانوس وساله ان يعمده فصبغه بنعمة المعمودية وصار مؤمناً ارتدكسيا وحلت عليه روح القدس وبعد ذلك قام وضم جسده رفيقه ذلك الشقى وتركه فى قبره واتيا الى القديس استافانوس وساله ان يقيمه فلم يفعل وبعد سوال كثير قاما الاثنى اعنى ارسطاديموس والقديس استافانوس واتيا الى قبر يواش الساحر وكان له ثلاث ايام من حيث مات وان ارسطاديموس بكى قايلًا تحن عليه وقيمه ليتوب من خطاياہ ونفاقه فقال له القديس مكتوب ان الذي يمجدينى انا امجده والذي يغضبون الله باعمالهم ينالون حزناً وفضيحة الى الابد لانهم تركوا الله وعبدوا الشياطين الارديا . وان ارسطاديموس قال له بحق السيد المسيح تحن عليه^(٣) فاما القديس اسطافانوس فكان انسان صالح رحوم قديس لما رأى دموع ارسطاديموس تحن عليه واتى الى المغارة وكان

(١) مخطوط ب : يضيف « فى اذان المجمع الواقف » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف « والوقت أنا ملاك قوى من السماء ومعه صوت نار » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر من « فاما ارسطاديموس لما رأى ... حتى » تحن عليه .

فبرى جسده للوقت وصار نقيا فلما رأى الرجل النعمة الذي ادركته من السيد المسيح على يد عبده القديس استافانوس خر عند رجليه فاقامه القديس قايلًا له قم يا ابنى ايمانك خلصك وان يواش الساحر لما رأى عظم الايه قال للقديس استافانوس وكل الجماعة انا ايضا . اصنع ايه باسم الهى وانه اخذ للوقت عجلاً وتكلم فى اذنه قايلًا هكذا بكلام سحر فانشق نصفين واستدعا بميزان فجاء النصفين سوا وان القديس استافانوس قال للمجمع هذا طلب الى الهته فاهلك هذا العجل ولكن يطلب اليهم ليقيمه حيا دفعة اخرى وان الساحر لم يقدر على ذلك^(١) فقام القديس استافانوس وحول وجهه الى ناحية الشرق وبسط يديه وصلى هكذا قايلًا يا سيدي يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى الذي جعلتنى مستحق أن أكون له تلميذاً اسمعنى أنا اليوم وقيم هذا العجل أمام هذا المجمع كله كى يؤمنوا أنك أنت الاله الحق الذي حيات كل احدا فى يديك وأنت المسلط . على كل شىء فيه نسمة الحياة الناس والبهائم وكل المخلوقات يتعبدوا لك وسلطان الحياة والموت بيدك أيها الاله الواحد الثالث المقدس الاب والابن والروح القدس الآن وكل أوان والى دهر الداهرين امين فلما أكمل القديس استافانوس صلاته أمرهم أن يلصقوا نصفين العجل مع بعضهم ففعلوا ذلك ومسك القديس استافانوس بقرنيه وقال له ايها العجل بقوت ربى يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى تحيا وتعود نفسك إليك وللوقت قام العجل حيا امام المجمع فصرخوا كلهم قايلين ليس إله الا يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى وان يواش الساحر قال انا اصنع آية اعظم من هذه^(٢) وانه عمل كرسيا ورفعته الشياطين وهو . جالسا عليه الى فوق الجوح حتى ظن المجمع انه رفع الى السما حيا وطلبوا يحيدوا عن الايمان فقال لهم القديس استافانوس تصبروا

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « وهوذا الساحر اهلك العجل بهلاك ابيه الشيطان فان كان يستطيع أن يقيمه وان الساحر لم يقدر ان يقيم العجل بالجملة » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يذكر « الساحر صنع كرسى من شعر الخنزير البرى واسنان لبوه فجلس عليه وعزم بأسماء الشياطين الجوح حينئذ ذلك الكافر رفع الى العلوه والكبرى حتى ان كلمن نظره قال انه قد ارتفع الى السماء » .

يتبعه قوم مؤمنين وجمع كبير من الجمع لان اسمه شاع في جميع يروشليم وكل تخومها وكانوا يمجّدوا الله بسببه وان القديس استافانوس امرهم ان يخرجوا جسد يواش الساحر من القبر ففعلوا كذلك وبسط يديه المقدستان وصلا قايلًا^(١) يا سيدي يسوع المسيح ابن الله الذي اقام العازر من القبر بعد اربعت ايام وصنع ايات كثيرة وامرنا نحن الرسل ان نبشر باسمه في العالم اقم هذا الساحر ليؤمنوا . بالهيئتك وتقوي قلوب المؤمنين بك لان لك المجد الى الابد امين * ٢٤١
ثم خر وسجد بوجهه على الارض قايلًا يا يواش يقيمك ربّي يسوع المسيح^(٢) فقام الميت وقفز هاربا^(٣) وان القديس استافانوس امر الجمع ان يمسكوه ويأتوا به اليه فرشمه^(٤) بعلامة الصليب المقدس وسلحه بمثال الصليب المجيد ونزع عنه الخوف الذي اعتراه من الموت وكل المتعبدن فاهدى روحه وقال مباركة هي الساعة الذي اجتمعت بك فيها يا رسول السيد المسيح القديس استافانوس^(٥) لانك اعنت نفسي وخلصتها من الجحيم السفلى وصنع الله معي الخير والنعمة ولم اعلم واعطاني النور والشمس والقمر والنجوم والسحب والريح والندا وخضرة . الارض لتكون لي طعاما واثمار الاشجار لأنهم من قبل صلاحه اعطاني هذا جميعه وانا اغضبته وخالفته ولم اطيع امره وانخطته بافعال الشيطان وكنت شرير ومجذف وكلما اریده ان يصنعوه لي الشياطين يصنعوه فلما ان مت طرحوني الشياطين الذي كنت اعبد لهم اسفل قاع الجحيم في العذاب والظلمة المذلّة والشدة والضيق والبكا وصرير الاسنان ليتني لم اولد في هذا العالم التعب حتى نالني هذا التعب العظيم في ذلك الموضع الذي لا تحصره العيون الويل^(٦)

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « قايلًا اعترف لك ايها الرب الاله واشكرك » بدلا من « يا سيدي . . . الابد امين » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف « ومسك بيده واقامه » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف « فلما رأى يواش القديس استافانوس خاف وهرب عنه » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يذكر « فرسمه قايلًا باسم ربّي يسوع المسيح ليهرب عنك مخافة العقوبة وللوقت اهتدى قلبه » بدلا من « بعلامة الصليب . . . فاهدى روحه » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « يا رسول السيد المسيح القديس استافانوس » .

(٦) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر من « الويل الويل . . . » الى « جل اسمه الاعانه على ذلك » .

الويل ثم الويل للكفار والوثنيين وكل من لا يعترف باسم يسوع المسيح . انه هو ابن الله انا وتجسد على الارض من الست السيدة العذرى و صلب ومات وقبر وقام من بين الاموات وصعد الى السموات بالجسد الذي اتخذه من العذرى وصار انساناً تاماً وهو الاله تاماً كاملاً الويل ثم الويل لمن ينكر مجيئه الى العالم ويقول انه ليس ابن الله فان ماواه واقامته في الظلمة البرانية والجحيم السفلى الموضع المنسى الذي لم تروحه رحمة الله بل نحن يا اخوه نؤمن ونعترف الى النفس الاخير ان السيد المسيح ابن الله الحى الازلى انا الى العالم وتجسد من مريم العذرى وولد منها ميلادا بشرياً من غير مباضعه بل حل روح القدس في احشائها بسر لا يدركه العقل . البشرى ومشى على الارض وصنع الايات وفعل افعال البشرية ما خلا الخطية و صلب ومات وقبر وقام من بين الاموات وصعد الى السموات وفي هذا كله لم يفارق اللاهوت الناسوت طرفة عين بل كان متحدًا به كاتحاد النار بالحديد وهو ايضا يأتى عند انقضاء العالم في مجد أبيه ليدين الاحياء والاموات فطوبيا يا اخوتي المسيحيين لمن ينتقل من هذه الدنيا الزائلة وهذه أمانته طوباهم ثم طوباهم ففسأل الرب الاله جل اسمه الاعانة على ذلك وان الساحر خر عند رجلى القديس استافانوس وسأله قايلًا ان^(١) يعطيه المعمودية المقدسة ورشم المسيح ليلا يمضى به الى العذاب دفعة ثانية وان القديس استافانوس . اعطاه نعمة^(٢) المعمودية وصار مولود من الما والروح كما قال الاله في انجيله المقدس الطاهر ان من لم يولد من الما والروح لا يعاين ملكوت الله لان من لا يعترف ان يسوع المسيح الذى انا بالجسد هو هو ابن الله الواحد الازلى لا ينال خلاص ولا مغفرة وبعد ذلك قام ارسطاديموس ويواش المؤمن واتوا بكتبهم وحرقوهم قدام كل احدا وصاروا موامنين احرار^(٣)

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « ان تعطى خاتم المسيح لكى انجبر ولا اعود الى العذاب دفعة اخرى في ذلك الموضع » بدلا من « ان يعطيه المعمودية المقدسة ورشم المسيح ليلا يمضى به الى العذاب دفعة ثانية » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يذكر « اعطاه الميلاد الجديد الذى للحياة ووعظه في الرب » بدلا من « اعطاه نعمة المعمودية . . . ولا مغفرة » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « احرار » عبيدا للمسيح .

وسط موضع الحكم واتوا بشهود زور وقالوا ان هذا الانسان جدف على موسى وعلى الله وعلى هذا الموضع المقدس ومخالفا للناموس وسمعناه يقول ان يسوع المسيح . الحق الذي هو الناصري يحل هذا الموضع ويقيم^(١) في ثلاث ايام ويغير العادات الذي دفعها لنا ابائنا وعن السيد موسى النبي وان القضاء الجلوس لمحاكمة القديس استافانوس تطلعوا في وجهه فراوه مثل ملاك الله وان ريس الكهنة قال حقاً هذا الذي قيل عنك وان القديس استافانوس امتلئ من روح القدس والايمان وقال امام الشعب يا ايها الرجال بني اسرائيل اخوتي واباي اسمعوا الان ان الاله المجد تراءيا لابينا ابراهيم حيث كان بين النهرين قبل ان يأتي ويسكن في حران وقال له اخرج من ارضك ومن عند بني جنسك وتعال الى الارض الذي اريك اياها وحيث خرج ابراهيم من ارض الكلدانيين انا وسكن في^(٢) كقول الرب ولما ات . ابوه نقله الله الى هذه الارض الذي اتم فيها بسكان اليوم ولم يعطيه فيها وطية قدم بل اوعده ان يورثها له ولزرعه من بعده ولم يكن له ولدا وكلمه الله هكذا قايل ان زرعك سيكون غريبا في ارض غريبة ويستعبدونه اربعمائة سنة والشعب الذي يستعبدوه سوف اعاقبه انا يقول الله وبعد هذا يخرجون ويعبدوني في هذا البلد ودفع اليه ميثاق الختان وهكذا ولد له اسحق فختنه في اليوم الثامن واسحق ولد يعقوب ويعقوب ولد ابائنا الاثنى عشر وابائنا تعصبوا على يوسف واباعوه الى مصر وكان الله معه وخلصه من جميع شدايده . واعطاه نعمة وحكمة وعلماً فاضلاً امام فرعون^(٣)

(١) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر «ويقيم» في ثلاث ايام .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف «في حران» .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف «ملك مصر وعلى جعله ملكا ربيسا على مصر وعلى اهل بيته جميعه

فانا على مصر وارض كنعان جوع عظيم فلم يجدوا ابائنا ما يقتاتون به فسمع يعقوب ان الغلة تباع بمصر فارسل ابائنا في الاول وفي الدفعة الثانية ظهر يوسف لاختوته وجنس يوسف ظهر لفرعون فارسل يوسف فدعا يعقوب ابيه وكل جنسه وكان عددهم خمسة وسبعين نفسا فنزل يعقوب مصر فات هو وابائنا وانقلوه الى شجيم [شكيم] ووضع في القبر الذي اشتراه ابراهيم بثمان الفضة من بني امون [حمور] في شجيم [شكيم] وكثل ما قرب زمان الموعد الذي قسم الله لابراهيم وقال اني انمي الشعب فكثرت الشعب في ارض مصر .

بالمعمودية وتخلصوا من عبودية الشيطان وصاروا عبيداً للمسيح ولما كان بعد ذلك كثروا التلاميذ^(١) ولم يلتفتوا لخدمت الارامل وان الرسل الاثنى عشر دعوا جماعة التلاميذ وقالوا لهم ان هذا الامر ما يرضينا ان نترك خدمت الله ونخدم الموائد فاطلبوا . سبعة رجال من الاخوه روحانيين يشهد عنهم انهم مملوون من روح القدس والحكمة فتركهم للخدمة وتفرغ نحن للصلاة فوافق الجماعة واختاروا استافانوس انسانا مملواً من الحكمة ونعمة روح القدس والايمان المستقيم وفيلبس^(٢) وابن وخورس ونيقانور وطيمون وفرمينا ونيقاليوس الرجل الانطاكي هولاي اقاموهم امام الرسل فصلوا ووضعوا عليهم الايادي وزادت كلمت الله ونمت وكثرت وكان عدد التلاميذ يكثر بيروشلیم جداً^(٣) وكان هذا القديس استافانوس يخدم الجماعة بنشاط وفرح عظيم ومحبة وهو مملواً من روح القدس^(٤) فرحا بالرجاء صابراً بالضيق دائم الصلوات متشارك . في حواريج القديسين محبا للغربا^(٥) مملواً من النعمة والقوة والحكمة والوداعة يصنع عجائب كثيرة وقوات في الشعب وان جماعة من الكفار^(٦) يشهدوا قائلين هذا جدف على الله وعلى موسى فاجتمعوا جمعاً كثيراً من كل المدن المحيطة بايروشلیم واحاطوا بالقديس استافانوس فلم يقدرُوا الثبوت امام الحكمة والروح الناطق فيه حينئذ^(٧) حركوا الشعب والمشيخة والكتبة كل الكهنة فقاموا ودخلوا الى اريوس فاغوس واوقفوا القديس استافانوس

(١) مخطوط ب : يضيف «فصارت مشاجرة بين اليونانيين والعبرانيين» .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يذكر «فيلبس وابروخوس وكانور وديمي وبرتوما ويوليس الغريب

الذي هو من اهل انطاكية» .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف «وكثير من اليهود سمعوا من ايمان استافانوس» .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يضيف «بلا مراياه ويهرب من الشر ويصنع الخير ويحب محبة الاخوه

ولا يكسل في الادب وهو مختار بالروح متعبد للرب» .

(٥) مخطوط ب : يضيف «يبارك كل من يلغنه لا يجازي شر بشر ولا شتيمة بشتيمة» .

(٦) مخطوط ب : يضيف «اقوام من الجمع الذين يدعون بهذا الاسم الارديوسيين والقيروانيين

والاسكندرانيين والقيليقيين والاسيين» .

(٧) مخطوط ب : يضيف «اتوا اناس الدين هم هؤلاء اسماءهم ريديفتوس واختلط الناس

من انطاكية فشهدوا قائلين انا سمعنا هذا يجدف على موسى وعلى الله» .

وكل جنوده وبعد ذلك قام ملك آخر^(١) لم يعرف^(٢) ابائنا فضيق علينا ودبر على جنسنا وامر ان يكون ولدانهم يلقون في النهر كيلا يعيشوا وفي تلك الايام ولد موسى وكان محبوبا عند الله فربى في بيت ابيه ثلاث شهور^(٣) ولما طرح^(٤) اخذته ابنة فرعون فلم يريد ان يصير لها ولدا^(٥) ولما كبر وصار ابن اربعون سنة^(٦) وجد رجلا من المصريين يخاصم رجلا من العبرانيين فقتل ذلك المصري ومن غد وجد رجلا من عبرانيين يختصم احدهما مع الآخر فطفق يطلب اليهما ان يصطلحا قايلا انما اخوان فلم يسي احدهما على الآخر فدفعه ذلك المسيي وقال من اقامك علينا . رئيسا وقاضيا العلك تريد قتلي كما قتل بالامس المصري فهرب موسى بهذه الكلمة وسكن ارض مدين وصار له هناك ابنان فلما تمت له اربعون سنة راي في برية^(٧) عليقة تشتعل النار وهي لم تحترق فتعجب وتقدم لينظر فقال له الرب بالصوت اخلع خفيك عن قدميك لان المكان الذي انت قايم فيه مقدس فارتعد موسى من صوت الرب وعرق عرقا شديدا فقال له الرب انا الاله ابايك اله ابراهيم واله اسحق واله يعقوب نظرت ضيق شعبي بمصر فنزلت وخلصتهم والان تعال الى مصر لارسلك^(٨) فوسى هذا الذي قال^(٩) ان الله الرب يقيم لكم . نبيا من اخوتكم مثلي له اطيعوا^(١٠) وان ٢٤٦ *

(١) مخطوط ب : يضيف « على مصر » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف « يوسف » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف « وكان اسمه اولا بلقيام » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يضيف « في البحر » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : يضيف « ودعت اسمه موسى قايلا اني اصعدته من الماء وتعلم موسى كل حكمة المصريين وكان قوى في كلامه واعماله » .

(٦) مخطوط ب : يضيف « جاء على قلبه ان يفتقد اخوته بني اسرائيل » .

(٧) مخطوط ب : يضيف « سينا » .

(٨) مخطوط ب : يضيف « هذا موسى الذي ابهر وقال له من الذي جعلك رئيسا وحاكم علينا فارسله الله رئيس ومنقذ بيد الملك (المسلك) الذي ظهر له في العوسجه فخرج من هناك وصنع ايات وعجائب في مصر وفي البحر الاحمر وفي البرية اربعين سنة » .

(٩) مخطوط ب : يضيف « لبني اسرائيل » .

(١٠) مخطوط ب : يضيف « فهذا الذي كان في الجماعة وفي البرية والملاك المتكلم معه على » .

الشعب وكل الكهنة الجلوس لما سمعوا كلام القديس استافانوس تعجبوا من النعمة الخارجة من فيه قائلين من اين هذا الكلام وهذه الحكمة وهذه العلم والادب واخرين كانوا يقولون ان الله ينطق على فيه وباركوا الرب الاله اله اسرائيل المعطى النعمة للناس هكذا وتعجبوا عجباً كثيراً فاجاب القديس وقال لهم^(١) ان قبة الشهادة الذي كانت مع اباينا كما امر موسى عن الذي تكلم معه ان يصنعها كالمثال الذي^(٢) راه هكذا طرحهم الله من وجهه اباينا الى ايام داوود الذي ظفر بالنعمة امام الله وسال ان يبني بيتا لاله يعقوب وسليمان ابنتاه والعلى لم يشا ان يسكن في صنعت الايدي كما قال^(٣) ان السما . كرسى والارض موطى قدماى فايما بيت تبنيه لى يقول الرب اى موضع هو راحتي اليس يداى صنعت هولاي كلهم يا غليظي الرقاب الغير محتونين بقلوبهم واذانهم انتم في كل وقت وحين مقاومين لروح القدس مثل اباؤكم من في الانبيا لم يضطهدوا اباؤكم قتلوا الذي سبقوا فانبأوا بمجى البار الحق يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى والذي انتم قتلتموه وصلبتموه وهو قام بقوة لاهوته في^(٤) اليوم الثالث وافضحكم ايها الكفرة واخذتم الناموس من يدي الملايكه ولم تحفظوه فلما سمعوا هذا صرخوا اسنانهم عليه وقالوا له ان الذي يكرز اسمه^(٥) ويدعو الناس الى الايمان

طورسينا ومع ابايكم هذا الذي قبلتم كلام الحياة منه ولم يطيعوه ابايكم بل تركوه وعادوا بقلوبهم بمصر وقالوا لهارون اصنع لنا الاله تمثى امامنا فهذا موسى الذي اخرجنا من ارض مصر لم يعرف ما كان منه فصنع لهم عجل في تلك الايام وقدموا الذبايح للأوثان وفرحوا بعمل يديهم وعاد الله وتركهم ليعبدوا قوات السماء مما هو مكتوب في سفر الانبياء هل الذبايح والقرايين قدمتموه لى في البرية اربعين سنة يا بيت اسرائيل واخذتوا مظلة مالوح ونجم الالهكم رافان التماثيل الذي سجدتوا له سأنقلكم الى نواحي بابل .

(١) مخطوط ب : يذكر « نطلب الشهادة التي اعطيت لابائنا » بدلا من « ان قبة الشهادة الذي كانت مع اباينا » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف « هذه الذي كانت معهم فقبلوها اباينا مع يسوع في قوة الامم الذي طردهم الله » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : يضيف « النبي » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « في اليوم الثالث وافضحكم ايها الكفرة » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « اسمه ويدعو الناس الى الايمان به » .

الست السيدة العذرى الطاهرة سيدت ملكت جميع النسوان مريم ابنت يواقيم الذي من جهلها كان خلاص ادم وذريته اجمعين بشفاعت هذا الشهيد والشماس الجليل المختار والرسول التلميذ البار الذي نحن مجتمعين الان لتذكاره ان يغفر خطايانا ويصفح عن اثمنا ويستر هفواتنا ويجعلنا مغفورين الذنوب مستورين الهفوات والعيوب فايزين بصالح الاعمال قبل فروغ الاجال وان يرخص اسعارنا ويعلموا نيلنا ويقوي مشايخنا والعفة لكهولنا والنشا الصالحة لاطفالنا ويحزن قلوب الملوك عليكم . ويخذل ويرذل ساير الاعداء المناصبين لنا وللبيعه المقدسه الجامعة الرسولية ويجعل كيدهم راجعا في نحرهم ويجعلنا مستحقين الوقوف والدخول اليها وبابها مفتوحا في وجوهنا على ممر الدهور والازمان ويغفر خطايانا ويثبتنا على الايمان المستقيم باسمه العظيم الى النفس الاخير بشفاعت الست السيدة العذرى الطاهرة والدة الاله سيدة نسا العالمين مريم ابنة يواقيم وساداتنا الرسل الاطهار الذي غلقوا بدعوتهم وتعالمهم أبواب البراني وفتحوا ابواب البيع وصلوات الشهداء المختارين وكلمن ارضا الرب الاله باعماله . الصالحة من ذرية آدم والى آخر الدهور كلها والسبح والمجد والتقديس والسجود والعظمة والوقار والسلطان والجبروت والملك الدائم بلا زوال للتالوت المقدس الاله الواحد الاب والابن والروح القدس الآن وكل اوان والى دهر الداهرين وابدا الابدن آمين .

* * *

سيرت الشهيد العظيم والشماس الكريم والرسول الامين استافانوس في يوم الخميس المبارك عاشر شهر ابيب المبارك سنة ١١٤٧ هـ والى الناسخ المسكين يضرب مطانوه تحت اقدام كلمن قرى فيه لن يدعوا له بالمساحة والغفران فانه عاجز وناقص علم وعمل ومن قال شئ . فله امتاله .

به ويقول عنه . انه ابن الله نحن نعرف انه ابن يوسف النجار وامه مريم ابنت يواقيم وارادوا ان يربطوه اعنى القديس استافانوس فامتلى من روح القدس وتفرس في السما فرأى يسوع قائما عن يمين الله ابيه فقال هوذا ارى السموات مفتوحة وابن البشر قائما عن يمين الله ابيه فسدوا اذانهم وتوعدوه ليلا يسمعوا الكلام واخذوه واختطفوه من وسط الجمع واخرجوه خارج المدينة بغضب عظيم وقلت رحمة وكان هناك واقفا حدثا يسمى شاوول^(١) وان الرجال الذي كانوا يرحموا القديس استافانوس وضعوا تيابهم عنده ففرح القديس استافانوس قائلا يا ربى يسوع المسيح^(٢) لا تحسب لهم هذه الخطية . واقبل^(٣) روحى اليك وجتا على ركبتيه ورجموه وتنيح بسلام واكمل^(٤) جهاده المقدس في اليوم الاول من طوبه^(٥) ونال^(٦) اكليل الشهادة في ملكوت السموات وصار اول الشهداء واول الشمامسة وان اناسا مومنين كفنوه ودفنوه في جانب الهيكل وان الرسل حزنوا حزنا كثيرا وتألموا لفقده ونال تلتة اكاليل في يروشلیم السماييه الواحد من اجل الرسولية والاخر لاجل الشهادة والاخر لاجل البتولية وبعد^(٧) ذلك بنيت البيع في كل العالم باسمه المقدس وكان ظهور جسده في اليوم الخامس عشر من شهر توت ونحن نسال ربنا والاهنا . ومخلصنا^(٨) يسوع المسيح ابن الله الحى الازلى رب البرية وخالق الوجود المتجسد من

(١) مخطوط ب : يضيف « الذى هو بولس » .

(٢) مخطوط ب : يضيف « اغفر لهذا الشعب » .

(٣) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « واكمل جهاده المقدس » .

(٤) مخطوط ب : يذكر « في اليوم الخامس عشر من شهر توت » .

(٥) مخطوط ب : لا يذكر « ونال . . . الشمامسة » .

(٦) مخطوط ب : ابتداء من « وبعد ذلك . . . » حتى نهاية المخطوط ١ يختلف المخطوط ب عنه

ونصفه كالآتى : « وغلب في الجهاد الصالح وكل سعيه جيذا وحفظ الامانة المستقيمة ومضى الى ملكوت السموات الى الذى احبه يسوع المسيح من قلبه وثبت في الامانة وصار راس زاوية البيعة المقدسة التى لربنا والاهنا ومخلصنا يسوع المسيح هذا الذى ينبغى له المجد والاكرام والسبح والسجود والهيبة والعظمة والوقار مع ابيه الصالح والروح القدس الحى المحي الآن وكل اوان والى دهر الداهرين وابدا الابدن آمين » .

TRANSLATION

* In the Name of the Father and of the Son and the Holy Spirit : *f. 234 r*
One God.

We begin with the help of God the Exalted and the excellence of His assistance to transcribe the biography of the glorious Saint and the honoured chosen vessel, the first martyr and the chief of the deacons, the grand Apostle Stephen (Iṣṭāfānūs), a disciple of Our Lord and Our God and Our Saviour Jesus Christ to Whom be the glory. He (Stephen) accomplished his contest on the first day of the month of Tūbah, ⁽¹⁾ the blessed. May his blessings and his prayers be with us. Amen.

Glory be to God, the Ancient, the Eternal, the First, Who is without beginning, to the Son, the Eternal, the Creator, and to the Life-giving Holy Spirit, Who is Consubstantial, the Perfect Trinity, One God, Who is without separation and without mixture and without mingling, the Invisible, the Incomprehensible, Who is above that which is above, and Who is below that which is below, to Whom is the unending rule of the Heaven and the Earth, Who knoweth Creation * before its existence, of Whom no place *f. 234 v* is devoid, and Whom no place containeth, and Whom no eyes circumscribe, and Whom no thought discovereth, the Possessor of all kingdoms, Who willed through His will and His Holy Spirit, at the end of the times, to descend from the Heaven, and to be incarnate of Mary (Maryam), the Pure Virgin, and the Lady of the Children of Adam (Adam). He was born in Bethlehem (Baīt Laḥm) of Judea (Yahudiyah). He performed the deeds of mankind, sin excepted. And He was baptized by John (Yuhanna), His kinsman, in the River Jordan (al-Urdon). He underwent for us baptism, and was crucified, and was buried, and rose from among the dead. He elected the Apostles and chose the Disciples and purified them.

⁽¹⁾ *i.e.* 9th January. MS. B has 15th Tūt = 25th September.

And it happened after His Ascension into the Heavens, when He sat in the bosom of His Father, which place He had never relinquished for the twinkling of an eye, He sent unto them the Holy Spirit, the Comforter, and they spake in all tongues. He supported them with signs and miracles and powers which created men* are unable to perform. He sent them to preach His great Name in the world, and he who believeth and is baptized shall be saved ⁽¹⁾. After His holy Ascension to above the Heavens ⁽²⁾, the Apostles returned from the mountain which is called the Mount of Olives, and they went into the world, preaching unto the people and calling them unto the Faith in the Holy Trinity, the One God. ⁽³⁾

There was in Jerusalem (Yarūšalīm) a man whose name was Simon (Sim'ān), the son of Zachaeus (Zakkā), and his wife was called Anna (Hannah). They were both ⁽⁴⁾ God-fearing people, righteous (and) pious, looking for the consolation of Israel (Isrāyil) ⁽⁵⁾, without blame before God, keeping His laws.

This Simon (Sim'ān) had two sons, one of them was called Juda (Yahūdā), and the other was called Stephen (Istāfanūs). He was meek, righteous and pious, observing the Holy Scriptures of God.* He went and attached himself to the Apostles, and he used to go in and to come out with them, and to minister unto them diligently, because he was virtuous, chaste, meek, and lowly, meek, righteous, pious, observing the Scriptures, and the grace of the Lord was upon him, being clothed with His Holy Spirit as with a robe. His speech was a sharp sword, (and) he used to dispute with the Jews (Yahūd) and with the Gentiles ⁽⁶⁾ and with

⁽¹⁾ *Mark*, XVI, 16. In *MS. B* the text from 'Glory be to God' up to 'shall be saved' is not found.

⁽²⁾ *MS. B* adds 'and He Sat at the right of His Father'.

⁽³⁾ In place of 'they went — One God' *MS. B* has, 'the disciples began to preach in Jerusalem, and a great multitude heard the Faith'.

⁽⁴⁾ In place of 'They were both, etc.' *MS. B* has 'He was'.

⁽⁵⁾ *Luke* II, 25.

⁽⁶⁾ *MS. B* has 'publicans'.

the Hanifites (al-Hunafā) ⁽¹⁾ and with the foreign nations ⁽²⁾, and he turned them to faith in Our Lord Jesus Christ to Whom be glory ⁽³⁾.

It happened in those days that a great multitude gathered unto the Apostles from all the countries which were around them, and from all the cities, and from among the inhabitants ⁽⁴⁾ of Mesopotamia (Bain an-Nahrain) and al-Kadā ⁽⁵⁾, the Arabes (al-'Arab), and (from) Cappadocia (al-Kabbadūkhiah) and Pontus (Buntus) and Asia (Asiyah) and Africa (Afrikīah) and Pamphylia (Bamfilīah) and part of Libya ⁽⁶⁾. All these gathered together (to hear) the teaching of the pure Apostles. Saint Stephen (Istāfanūs) used to perform many signs and powers* among the people in the Name of Our Lord and Our God and Our Saviour Jesus Christ, and to cast out unclean spirits, and to place his hand upon sick that they might be healed. His face used to shine with the grace of the Holy Spirit, as (that of) the pure angels, and if (he spake he used to utter) a goodly speech, for the Holy Spirit spake by his mouth.

The Apostles loved him exceedingly, for to him who asked him concerning anything, he answered immediately with a speech sharp as a sword, since he spake through the Holy Spirit, and (with) perfect politeness, and he instructed the multitude in order that they might enter into the knowledge of God and the right faith.

One day, he was sitting and teaching the people that they should shun evil, saying in this manner, that upon him who followed ⁽⁷⁾

⁽¹⁾ *i.e.* those of the religion of Abraham.

⁽²⁾ *MS. B.* omits 'and with the foreign nations'.

⁽³⁾ *MS. B* adds 'and he cast out godlessness from the race of men'.

⁽⁴⁾ *MS. B* reads as follows: 'they are from Pontus (Bunūtus) Nīmītus (*sic*), and the inhabitants of Mesopotamia (al-Ġazīrat al-Wustā) and Africa (Afrikīah) and Pamphylia (Bamfilīah) and Egypt (Miṣr) and parts of Libya (Lūniya). The Jews (al-Yahūd) and the foreigners, al-Kadā (*sic*) and the Arabs (al-'Arab)'.

⁽⁵⁾ *sic*.

⁽⁶⁾ *MS. B* reads Lūtiah.

⁽⁷⁾ *Lit.* 'is in'.

f. 236 v the Gospel of Christ, the Son of the Eternal God, and (Who) was beneath the veil of the assembly* which the Lord Christ had acquired with His blood, it was incumbent to abandon filthy deeds, such as ⁽¹⁾ adultery, defilement, murder, lewdness, dissension levity, calumny, enmity, envy, perjury, drunkenness, jesting, anger and greed ⁽²⁾, all of which ⁽³⁾, in truth, anger God.

f. 237 r While Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) was speaking these words with the assembly, they brought unto him a man who had ⁽⁴⁾ the dropsy, and they went in with him to the place ⁽⁵⁾, and they set him beneath his feet, and they besought him concerning him. As for him, when he saw their faith, he signed the heart ⁽⁶⁾ of that man and his ears, saying: « May Our Lord Jesus Christ Who came to give life to the sinners and commanded His Name to be preached in the world, heal thee! ». In that hour that man was healed from his sickness ⁽⁷⁾. When ⁽⁸⁾ the chief of the assembly saw * this, he believed, he and the members of his house, and many people (also), and they were baptized and were saved from their sins. And the Apostles and the assembly increased, and they preached the Name of Our Lord and Our God and Our Saviour Jesus Christ. And the number of the disciples multiplied in Jerusalem (Yarūsālīm), and the grace of God increased exceedingly in the assembly of the faithful ⁽⁹⁾.

Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) was teaching the people with the words of Our Lord Jesus Christ.

⁽¹⁾ Lit. 'which are'.

⁽²⁾ Lit. 'love of the greater share'.

⁽³⁾ Lit. 'these'.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds 'a demon'.

⁽⁵⁾ In place of 'and they went — place' MS. B has 'he was carried'.

⁽⁶⁾ MS. B has 'belly'.

⁽⁷⁾ MS. B adds 'His belly opened and also his thighs, and much pus came out, and he was healed'.

⁽⁸⁾ MS. B adds. 'Archelaus'.

⁽⁹⁾ Cf. Acts VI, 7.

It happened, on a certain day, that two magicians from the city Ephesus (Afsis) and from (the province of) Galatia (Ghalāṭiah) came to him; the name of one of them was Yûās and the other (was) Aristodemus (Aristādīmūs) ⁽¹⁾. This one said to Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs): « I wish to know in the name of whom of the gods ⁽²⁾ thou workest these signs? ». Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) answered, saying: « These (signs are wrought) through the God of the heaven and the earth and the seas and the rivers * and of all the creatures, the Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the Living (and) the Eternal God Whose disciple I am, preaching His name in all the world, and He is the God of gods and the Lord of lords ».

While Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) was speaking of these (things), a great multitude came unto him, and lo, a man, a leper, approached him, saying: « I ask thee, O holy honoured Apostle Stephen (Istāfānūs) to place thy hands upon me that I may be healed of my sickness ». When Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) saw that he had the faith to be saved, he placed his hand upon him, and he said to him: « In the Name of my Lord Jesus Christ, be cleansed from thy sickness ». And he signed him with the holy sign ⁽³⁾, and his body was healed immediately, and he became clean. When the man saw the grace which had come upon him from the Lord Christ, at the hands of his servant, Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), he fell at his feet, but the Saint raised him up, saying to him: « Arise, O my son, thy faith hath saved thee ⁽⁴⁾ ». And when Yûās ⁽⁵⁾,

⁽¹⁾ In the Acts of John, cf. M.R. JAMES, *The Apocryphal New Testament*, Oxford 1924, p. 262, the name of the pagan high priest is Aristodemus. MS. B reads as follows: 'one of them who was from Ephesus (Afsus) came to Jerusalem and his name was Aristodemus (Aristādīmūs), and the other was from Galatea (Ghalāṭiah) and he went to Jerusalem, and his name was Yûās'.

⁽²⁾ MS. B adds 'by Hermes (Harmis), by — Aṣīdūn, by Artemis (Ardamīs) who is — Lāīnās'.

⁽³⁾ i.e. the sign of the Cross.

⁽⁴⁾ Cf. Mark X, 52; Luke XVIII, 42.

⁽⁵⁾ The spelling of this name now changes to Yûās.

* f. 238 r^o the magician, saw the greatness of the sign, he said to Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) and all the assembly : « (See) what sign I, also, * work in the name of my gods ». And he took immediately a calf and spake in its ear, saying, in this manner, the words of a charm, and it was rent in twain. He sent for a pair of scales, and the twain proved to be equal. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) said to this assembly : « He besought his gods, and this calf was killed; but let him beseech them that they ⁽¹⁾ revive it ». The magician was not able (to do) that ⁽²⁾. Then Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) arose, and he turned his face in the direction of the east, and he stretched forth his hands, and he prayed thus, saying : « O my Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the Living God, Who hast made me worthy to be a disciple of Thine ⁽³⁾, hearken unto me to-day, and revive this calf before all this assembly, so that they may believe that thou art the true God, in Whose hands is the life of everyone, and that thou reignest * over every thing in which is the breath of life. Men and beasts and all created things shall worship Thee. The power of life and death is in Thy hand, O One God, Holy Trinity, Father and Son and Holy Sprit, now and always, and unto the age of the ages. Amen ».

* f. 238 v^o

When Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) had finished his prayer, he ordered them to attach the two parts of the calf, the one to the other, and they did so. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) grasped its two horns and said to it : « O calf through the might of my Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the Living God, mayest thou live, and may thy soul return to thee », and immediately the calf rose up alive before the assembly. Then they all cried out, saying : « There is no God, save Jesus Christ, the Son of the Living God ». And Yûâš, the magician, said : « I will perform a sign greater than

⁽¹⁾ MS. reads 'he'.

⁽²⁾ Cf. *Mark* X, 52; *Luke* XVIII, 42.

⁽³⁾ MS. B has 'This magician destroyed the Calf by the destruction of his father the Devil (aš-Šaiṭān). And if he can revive it, (let him do so)'. But the magician could not revive the calf at all.

this » ⁽¹⁾; and he made a chair, and devils (aš-Šayāṭīn) raised him up, * as he sat on it, high into the air so that the assembly thought that he was being borne up to the Heaven alive, and they sought to turn aside from the Faith. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) said unto them : « Be patient, O brethren, and believe in Our Lord Jesus Christ, (and) see the glory of this Divinity », and he arose immediately, and he prayed in this manner, saying : « O my Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the Living God, the Saviour of my soul and my body, hearken unto me, I, Thy sinful servant, lest my labour be destroyed and become as nothing, and lest this hypocrite say that there is no God for us, and destroy the souls of those who believe in Thee, O Lord, the Almighty. Grant unto Thy servant power and steadfastness before this assembly, for thou art a merciful Lord and a true King, and Thine is the glory for ever. Amen ».

* f. 239 r^o

When Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) had uttered * this speech, he fell upon his knees ⁽²⁾ and prostrated himself, worshipping God with his face on the earth. And suddenly there was a great commotion in the sky and much fear ⁽³⁾, and lo, an angel of the Lord called out with power, and cried out a loud voice from the Heaven, saying : « Let that impious (one) be removed, lest he see the glory of God »; ⁽⁴⁾ and the angel of God smote the devils (aš-Šayāṭīn) who bore the chair of that impious (one) ⁽⁴⁾, and they abandoned him, and they descended from the height of the Heaven to the depth of the earth, and he was broken ⁽³⁾ into pieces, and he died, (and) his death (was) most evil; and the assembly lifted up their voices, saying : « There is no God, save Jesus Christ, the Son

⁽¹⁾ MS. B has 'The magician made a chair from the hair of a wild boar and the teeth of a lioness. Then he sat on it, and he invoked the names of the famous devils (aš-Šayāṭīn) in the air. Thus this godless one was raised up on high, he and the chair, so that every one beholding him, said that he was raised to the heaven.

⁽²⁾ MS. reads 'knee'.

⁽³⁾ MS. B adds 'in the ears of the multitude present'.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds 'and immediately there came a powerful angel from the heaven with a voice of fire'.

of the Living God, Who is preached in His Name in the world». And there believed in Our Lord Jesus Christ in th t hour three thousand souls. As for Aristodemus ⁽¹⁾ (Arsatādīmūs), when he saw what had happened, he believed in Our Lord Jesus Christ, *and he worshipped Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), and he asked him to baptize him; and he baptized him with the grace of the baptism, and he became an Orthodox believer, and the Holy Sprit came down upon him. After this, he arose and gathered up the body of his companion, that wretched man, and he deposited it in a ⁽²⁾ tomb, and he came ⁽³⁾ to Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) and he besought him to raise him up, but he did not do (so). After many requests, they both rose up, namely, Aristodemus (Arsatādīmūs) and Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), and they both came to the tomb of Yûâš, the magician, and it was three days since he had died. Aristodemus (Arsatādīmūs) wept, saying: «Have pity upon him and raise him up, in order that he may repent of his sins and his hypocrisy». The Saint said unto him: «It is written that he who glorifieth Me, I will glorify him ⁽⁴⁾, and those who anger God by their deeds shall receive grief and opprobrium for ever, because they have forsaken God and have worshipped evil devils (aš-Sayātīn).

f. 240 v * Aristodemus (Arsatādīmūs) said to him: «By the truth of the Lord Christ, have pity upon him. As for Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), he was an upright, merciful Saint, (and), when he saw the tears of Aristodemus (Arsatādīmūs), he had pity upon him, and he went to the cave, and there followed him faithful people and great multitudes of the assembly, because his name had spread in all Jerusalem (Yarūsālīm), and in all its borders, and they were glorifying God an account of him. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) ordered them to take out the body of Yûâš, the magician, from the tomb, and they did so, and he stretched forth his holy

⁽¹⁾ MS. B omits from 'As for Aristodemus — have pity upon him'.

⁽²⁾ Lit. 'his'.

⁽³⁾ MS. reads 'both came' (sic).

⁽⁴⁾ Cf. John XII, 26.

hands and prayed, saying ⁽¹⁾: «O my Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, Who raised Lazarus (Al-'Azar) from the tomb after four days, and (Who) wrought many signs, and (Who) ordered us, the Apostles, to preach His Name in the world, raise this magician, *so that may believe in Thy Divinity, and the hearts of the faithful may be strengthened through Thee, for Thine is the glory for ever. Amen».

Then he prostrated himself, and he worshipped with his face on the earth, saying: «O Yûâš, may my Lord Jesus Christ raise thee», ⁽²⁾ and he who was dead arose, and leaped up, fleeing away ⁽³⁾.

Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) ordered the assembly to seize him, and they brought him to him. He signed him with the sign of the Holy Cross, and he traced (ⲱⲱⲗⲁ) upon him the pattern of the Glorious Cross, and he removed from him the fear which had come upon him from death, and from all subjugators, and he calmed his soul ⁽⁴⁾. He (Yûâš) said: «Blessed be the hour in which I came together with thee, O Apostle of the Lord Christ, Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) ⁽⁵⁾, for thou hast helped my soul and hast saved it from the lower hell. God wrought with me goodness and grace and I did not know it. He gave to me the light and the sun and the moon, and the stars and the clouds and the wind, and the dew and the herbs* of the earth that they might be food ⁽⁶⁾ for me, and the fruits of the trees that I might partake of them. In His goodness He gave all these (things) to me, and I angered Him, and I disobeyed Him, and I did not obey His

⁽¹⁾ MS. B has in place of «O my Lord — Amen» the following: «I confess to Thee, O Lord, my God, and I thank Thee».

⁽²⁾ MS. B adds 'and he took him by his hand and raised him'.

⁽³⁾ MS. B has 'And when Yûâš saw Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), he was afraid, and he fled'.

⁽⁴⁾ In place of 'with the sign — his soul' MS. B has 'saying «In the Name of my Lord Jesus Christ may the fear of punishment be removed from thee», and immediately his heart was calmed'.

⁽⁵⁾ MS. B omits from 'O Apostle — Stephen'.

⁽⁶⁾ Lit. 'my food'.

commandment, (and) I provoked Him by devilish (aš-Šayātīn) works. I was evil and blasphemous, and all that I wished that the devils (aš-Šayātīn) should do for me, they did it, but when I died, the devils whom I had worshipped cast me down to the bottom of hell, in torment and intense darkness, and (in) difficulty and distress, and (with) weeping and gnashing of teeth. Would that I had not been born into this weary world, that this great weariness might not have befallen me in that place, which the eye cannot circumscribe! Woe ⁽¹⁾, woe, and again woe unto the godless and the heathen, and unto everyone who doth not acknowledge the Name of Jesus Christ*, that He is the Son of God, (Who) came and took a body on the earth from the Lady, the Mistress the Virgin, and was crucified and He died and was buried, and (Who) rose from among the dead and ascended into the Heavens with the body which He took from the Virgin, and (Who) became perfect man, being also perfect and absolute God. Woe and again woe unto him who denieth His coming into the world, and (who) saith that He is not the Son of God; his abode and his dwelling-place shall be in the outer darkness and the lower hell, the forgotten-place to which the mercy of God doth not reach. But we, O brethren, believe and confess until our ⁽²⁾ last breath, that the Lord Christ, the Son of the Living and the Eternal God, came into the world and took a body from my Lady Mary (Martmaryam), the Virgin, and was born from Her according to human birth, without copulation, but the Holy Spirit descended Her womb through a mystery which the human mind comprehendeth not.

f. 242 v *And He (Jesus Christ) walked on earth, and He wrought signs and performed the works of men, sin excepted; and He was crucified and died and was buried, and He rose from among the dead and ascended unto the Heavens, and in all this (His) Divinity was not separated from (His) Humanity for the twinkling

⁽¹⁾ MS. B omits from 'Woe, woe — Whose Name is exalted for assistance in this'.

⁽²⁾ Lit. 'the'.

of an eye, but It (the Divinity) was united with It (the Humanity), as the union of fire with iron; and He shall come again at the end of the world, in the glory of His Father, to judge the living and the dead. Blessed, O my Christian brethren, is he who departeth from this transitory world, this being his faith. Blessed are they, and again blessed are they. We ask the Lord God, Whose Name is exalted for assistance in this. The magician prostrated himself at the feet of Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), and he besought him, saying that he should confer on ⁽¹⁾ him holy baptism and the seal of Christ ⁽²⁾, lest he should be brought a second time into torment. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs)* gave to him the grace of baptism, and he was born of water and of the Spirit, as God saith in His Holy and Pure Gospel: « Unless one be born of water and of the Spirit, he shall not see the kingdom of God! » ⁽³⁾. For he who confesseth not that Jesus Christ Who came in the flesh is the Son of God, the One and the Eternal ⁽⁴⁾, shall not receive salvation nor forgiveness ⁽⁵⁾. After this, Aristodemus (Aristādīmūs) and Yûâš the believer arose, and they brought their books, and they burnt them before everyone, and they became believers (and) free by baptism, and were saved from the servitude of Satan (aš-Saytān), they became servants of Christ ⁽⁶⁾.

It happened after this, when the disciples were multiplying ⁽⁷⁾, and were not paying heed to the ministration of the widows, that the twelve Apostles called the multitude of the disciples,

⁽¹⁾ Lit. 'give to'. MS. B has here 'that thou givest to me the seal of Christ that I may be saved, and that I may not return to torment a second time in 'that place'.

⁽²⁾ i.e. Chrismation.

⁽³⁾ Cf. John III, 3.

⁽⁴⁾ Cf. I John: IV, 3*, 2*.

⁽⁵⁾ In place of 'the grace of baptism — forgiveness' MS. B has 'regeneration which 'is of life, and he exhorted him in the Lord'.

⁽⁶⁾ MS. B omits from 'free — Christ'.

⁽⁷⁾ MS. B adds 'there happened a murmuring of the Greeks (al-Yūnāniyin) and the Hebrews (al-Ibrāniyin)'.

and they said unto them : « This matter doth not befit us that we should forsake the ministration of God, and serve tables. *f. 243 v* Seek out, * therefore, seven men of the spiritual brethren, concerning whom it is testified that they are full of the Holy Spirit and of wisdom, that we may leave to them this ministration, and (that) we may devote ourselves to prayer ». The multitude consented, and they chose Stephen (Istāfānūs), a man full of wisdom and of the grace of the Holy Spirit and of the right faith, and Philip (Filibus), and Prochorus (Ibnūkhūrus, *sic*), and Nicanor (Tikānūr *sic*), and Timon (Timūn), and Parmenas (Farmīnā), and Nicolas (Nifālyūs) ⁽¹⁾, a man of Antioch (al-Antāki) ⁽²⁾. These they set before the Apostles and they prayed, and they laid hands on them. And the word of God increased and grew and multiplied, and the number of the disciples was multiplying in Jerusalem (Yarūšālīm) exceedingly ⁽³⁾. This Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) was serving the assembly with diligence and great joy and love; being full of the Holy Spirit ⁽⁴⁾, rejoicing in hope, patient in tribulation, continuing in prayer, * administering to the necessities of the Saints, loving strangers ⁽⁵⁾, full of grace, and power and wisdom and meekness, (and) he wrought many miracles and mighty deeds among the people ⁽⁶⁾. And multitude of the godless ⁽⁷⁾ bare

⁽¹⁾ MS. B reads for Nicanor 'Kanūr', for Timon 'Dīmni', for Parmenas 'Bartāmā', for Nicolas 'Yulās'.

⁽²⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 1-6.

⁽³⁾ Acts VI, 7. MS. B adds 'Many of the Jews (al-Yahūd) listened to the faith of Stephen (Istāfānūs)'.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds 'without craftiness, fleeing from evil, doing good, showing love for the brethren, not remiss in decorum, chosen by the Spirit, adoring the Lord'.

⁽⁵⁾ Cf. Rom. XII, 12-13. MS. B adds 'He blessed every one who cursed him; he did not recompense evil for evil nor insult for insult', cf. Rom. XII, 14 and 17.

⁽⁶⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 8.

⁽⁷⁾ MS. B adds 'peoples from the multitudes which are called the Libertines (Ardadbūsiyin) and the Cyrenians, and the Alexandrians, and the Cilicians, and the Asiatics'.

witness, saying : « This (man) hath blasphemed against God and against Moses (Mūsā) ⁽¹⁾. A great multitude gathered from all the cities which are around Jerusalem (Airūšālīm), and they surrounded Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs), but they were not able to withstand ⁽²⁾ the wisdom and the Spirit speaking within him ⁽³⁾. Then ⁽⁴⁾ they stirred up the people and the elders and the scribes and all the priests ⁽⁵⁾. They stood, and they entered the Areopagus (Ariūs Faghūs) ⁽⁶⁾, and they set Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) in the midst of the place of judgment, and they brought false witness and they said : « This man blasphemed against Moses (Mūsā), and against God and against this holy place ⁽⁷⁾, transgressing the Law. And we heard him saying that Jesus Christ, * the True *f. 244 v* (One), Who is the Nazarene (an-Nāsrī), will abolish this place and will raise it up in three days ⁽⁸⁾, and will change the customs which our fathers delivered unto us and (which were given) by the Lord Moses (Musā). The judges sitting to judge Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) looked at his face, and they saw it as that of an angel of God. And the high priest said : « Is this true what is said concerning thee ? » ⁽⁹⁾. Saint Stephen (Istāfānūs) was filled with the Holy Spirit and faith, and he said before the people : O men, Children of Israel (Isrāyīl), my brethren and my fathers, hearken now. The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham (Ibrāhīm)

⁽¹⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 11.

⁽²⁾ Lit. 'stand firm before'.

⁽³⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 10.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds 'there came people whose name is Ridīkiūs (*sic*), and people from Antioch (Antākīah) were mixed, and they witnessed, saying : 'We have heard this man blaspheming against Moses (Mūsā) and against God' ».

⁽⁵⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 12.

⁽⁶⁾ The writer has forgotten that he is describing events at Jerusalem and not at Athens !

⁽⁷⁾ i.e. the Temple at Jerusalem.

⁽⁸⁾ MS. B omits 'and will raise it up in three days'.

⁽⁹⁾ Cf. Acts. VI, 14-VII, 1.

there, where he was in Mesopotamia (Bain an-Nahraïn), before he came and dwelt in Haran (Harân), and he said to him: 'Go forth from thy land ⁽¹⁾ and from the children of thy race, and come into the land which I shall show to thee'. Then Abraham (Ibrâhîm) came out from the land of the Chaldeans (al Kildāniyîn), and he came and dwelt in ⁽²⁾, according to the word of the Lord. When his father died, * God removed him into this land in which we are dwelling to-day, and He (God) gave not to him a foot-step in it, but He promised to him that He would give it as an inheritance to him, and to his seed after him, and he (Abraham) had no son. The word of God (was) thus, saying: «Thy seed ⁽³⁾ shall dwell as strangers in a strange land, and they (the strangers) shall enslave them for four hundred years, and the people who shall enslave them, I shall punish», saith God. After this, they shall come forth, and they shall worship Me in this land. He (God) gave to him the Covenant of the Circumcision, and so he (Abraham) begat Isaac (Ishak), and he circumcised him on the eighth day, and Isaac (Ishak) begat Jacob (Ya'kûb), and Jacob (Ya'kûb) begat our twelve fathers. And our fathers seized Joseph (Yūsuf), and they sold him into Egypt (Miṣr), and God was with him, and He delivered him from all his afflictions, * and He gave him grace and wisdom and good knowledge before Pharaoh (Far'un) ⁽⁴⁾ and all his troops. And after this, another king arose ⁽⁵⁾ who knew not our fathers ⁽⁶⁾, and he oppressed us, and he dealt craftily with our race, and he ordered that their children should be cast into the river so that they might not live. In those days Moses (Musā) was born, and he was

⁽¹⁾ Cf. *Acts*. VII, 2-3 *.

⁽²⁾ Supply « Harzan » which is the reading of MS. B.

⁽³⁾ Cf. *Acts*. VII, 1-10.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds here the text of *Acts*. VII, 10-17.

⁽⁵⁾ MS. B adds 'over Egypt (Miṣr)'.

⁽⁶⁾ MS. B has in place of 'fathers', 'Joseph (Yūsif)'.

beloved of God, and he was nourished in the house of his father for three months ⁽¹⁾, and when he was cast into the river ⁽²⁾, the daughter of Pharaoh (Far'un) took him, but he wished not to be a child of hers. When he grew up, and he was forty years old ⁽³⁾, he found a man of the Egyptians (al-Maṣriyîn) quarrelling with a man of the Hebrews (al-Ibrāniyîn) and he killed that Egyptian (al-Miṣri). And, on the morrow, he found two Hebrew (Ibrāniyāin) men quarrelling, the one with the other. He began to beseech them to be reconciled, saying: «Ye (are) both brethren, why doth one of you do wrong to the other». Then he who did wrong repulsed him, and he said: «Who set thee up as chief and judge over us?». * May be thou wishest to kill me, as thou ⁽⁴⁾ killedst yesterday the Egyptian (al-Maṣri)?». Moses (Mūsā) fled at this word, and he dwelt in the land of Midian (Midyan), and there he had two sons. When forty years were completed, he saw in a desert ⁽⁵⁾ a bush blazing with fire, and it was not burnt. He marvelled and approached to see. The Lord said to him in a voice: «Take off thy shoes from thy feet, for the place upon which thou art standing is holy». Moses (Mūsā) trembled at the voice of the Lord, and he sweated exceedingly ⁽⁶⁾. The Lord said to him: «I am the God of thy fathers, the God of Abraham (Ibrâhîm), the God of Isaac (Ishak) and the God of Jacob (Ya'kûb). I have seen the affliction of my people in Egypt (Miṣr), and I am come down to deliver them. And now go unto Egypt (Miṣr), that I may send thee ⁽⁶⁾. And this Moses (Musā) (it was), who

⁽¹⁾ MS. B adds 'and his name was at first Balkiām'.

⁽²⁾ 'into the river' reading from MS. B. MS. B adds 'And she called his name Moses (Mūsā), saying: 'I drew him from the water'. (*Ex.* II, 10 *). And Moses (Mūsā) learned all the wisdom of the Egyptians, and was mighty in his words and his deed' (*Acts*. VII, 22).

⁽³⁾ *Lit.* 'he became a son of forty years'. MS. B adds here 'And it came into his heart to visit his brethren the Children of Israel'.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B adds 'of Sina', cf. *Acts* VII, 30.

⁽⁵⁾ *Lit.* 'a great sweating'.

⁽⁶⁾ MS. B adds *Acts* VII, 35-36.

*f. 246 v° said ⁽¹⁾ that God, the Lord, would raise up unto you * a prophet from among your brethren, like unto me, obey him » ⁽²⁾. When the people and all the priests (who were) sitting (there), heard the speech of Saint Stephen (Iṣṭāfānūs), they marvelled at the grace coming forth from his mouth, (and) they said ⁽³⁾: « From whence is this speech and this wisdom and this knowledge and this learning? ». And others said that God was speaking through his mouth. They blessed the Lord God, the God of Israel (Iṣrāyīl), Who giveth grace to the people in this manner, and they marvelled exceedingly ⁽⁴⁾. The Saint answered and said unto them: « The Tabernacle of the Witness which our fathers had ⁽⁵⁾, as Moses (Mūsā) commanded, concerning which ⁽⁶⁾ He spake with him, that he should make it according to the likeness which he had seen ⁽⁷⁾. In this manner, God cast them (the nations) out before the face of our fathers, up to the days of David (Dāwūd) who found grace before God, and (who) asked to build a house for the God of Jacob (Ya'kūb). But Solomon (Sulāimān) built it, but the Most High wished not to dwell in (houses) made with hands, as He saith ⁽⁸⁾: « The Heaven * (is) My throne, and the earth (is) the footstool of My feet. What house will ye build for me? saith the Lord: or what is the place of my rest? Did not my hands make all these (things)? O stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart ⁽⁹⁾ and ears ⁽¹⁰⁾, always and at all times ye resist the Holy

⁽¹⁾ MS. B adds 'to the Children of Israel', of *Acts* VII, 37.

⁽²⁾ MS. B adds here *Acts* VII, 38-43.

⁽³⁾ Lit. 'saying'.

⁽⁴⁾ Lit. 'a great marvelling'.

⁽⁵⁾ MS. has in place of 'The Tabernacle of the Witness which our fathers had' the following 'We seek the witness which was given to our father'.

⁽⁶⁾ الذى to give sense here must be made a relative pronoun of the antecedent 'Tabernacle of the Witness'.

⁽⁷⁾ MS. B adds here *Acts* VII, 45°.

⁽⁸⁾ In place of 'as He saith' MS. B has 'as saith the prophet', cf. *Acts* VII, 48.

⁽⁹⁾ Lit. 'their hearts'.

⁽¹⁰⁾ Lit. 'their ears'.

Spirit, as your fathers (did). Which among the prophets did not your fathers persecute? They killed them who foretold the coming of the righteous and true Jesus Christ, the Son of the Living God, Whom ye killed and crucified ⁽¹⁾. He rose through the power of His Divinity on the third day and put you to shame, O Unbelievers ⁽²⁾ (ye who) received the Law from the hands of angels and kept it not ».

When they heard this, they gnashed on him with their teeth ⁽³⁾, and they said to him: « He Whose Name ⁽⁴⁾ is preached, and (Who) calleth the people to belief in Him, and concerning Whom it is said * that the (is) the Son of God, we know that the (is) the son of Joseph (Yūsuf) the carpenter, and his mother, Mary (Maryam), (is) the daughter of Joachim (Yuākīm) ». They wished to bind him, namely, Saint Stephen (Iṣṭāfānūs). He being full of the Holy Spirit, looked up into the heaven and saw Jesus (Yasū) standing at the right hand of God, His Father, and he said: « Behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God, His Father ». They stopped their ears, and they threatened him in order that they might not hear (his) speech; and they seized him and carried him away from the midst of the assembly, and they cast him outside the city with great wrath and without mercy. There was a young man standing there named Saul (Šāwūl) ⁽⁵⁾ and the men who stoned Saint Stephen (Iṣṭāfānūs) placed their garments with him. Saint Stephen (Iṣṭāfānūs) cried out saying: « O my Lord Jesus Christ ⁽⁶⁾ lay not this sin * to their charge, and receive unto Thee my spirit »; and he knelt on his knees, and they stoned him, and he went to his rest in peace ⁽⁷⁾; and he completed his holy contest ⁽⁸⁾ on the

⁽¹⁾ Cf. *Acts* VII, 44-52.

⁽²⁾ MS. B omits 'on the third day — Unbelievers'.

⁽³⁾ Cf. *Acts* VII, 54.

⁽⁴⁾ MS. B omits 'Whose Name'.

⁽⁵⁾ MS. B adds 'who is Paul (Būlus)'.
⁽⁶⁾ MS. B adds 'forgive this people'.

⁽⁷⁾ Cf. *Acts* VII, 55-60.

⁽⁸⁾ MS. B omits 'and he completed his holy contest'.

first day of Tûbah⁽¹⁾, and he received the crown of martyrdom in the Kingdom of the Heavens. He became the first martyr, and (was) the first of the deacons⁽²⁾. Faithful people shrouded him and buried him at the side of the Temple. The Apostles mourned exceedingly⁽³⁾, and they suffered from his loss. He received three crowns in the Heavenly Jerusalem (Yarûšalim), one on account of (his) Apostolate, another on account of (his) Martyrdom, and another on account of (his) Virginity⁽⁴⁾. After this⁽⁵⁾, churches were built throughout the whole world in his holy name. The invention of his body was on the 15th day of the month of Tût⁽⁶⁾. We beseech Our Lord and Our God* and Our Saviour Jesus (Yasû') Christ, Son of the Living and the Eternal God, Lord of created things and Creator of the Creation, He Who took flesh of the Mistress, the Lady, the Pure Virgin, the Lady (and) Queen of all women, daughter of Joachim (Yûâkîm), my Lady Mary (Martmaryam) by Whom was the salvation of

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⁽¹⁾ i.e. 9th January. MS. B has here 'the fifteenth day of the month of Tût'. In the MS. A this date is given for the Invention of the body of Saint Stephen.

⁽²⁾ MS. B omits 'and he received — — deacons'.

⁽³⁾ Lit. 'much mourning'.

⁽⁴⁾ For the writer of this apocryphon Saint Stephen was an unmarried man, whereas, the writer of the Coptic apocryphon of Saint Stephen states that he was married and the father of a daughter, cf. YASSÂ 'ABD AL-MASÎH, 'A Coptic Apocryphon of Saint Stephen' 'the Archdeacon' in *Le Muséon*, t. LXX, pp. 329-347.

⁽⁵⁾ From this point up to the end of the MS. A there is the following text in MS. B which, as will be seen, is quite different. 'He vanquished in the good warfare, and he accomplished well his contest, and he kept the right faith, and he went to the Kingdom of the Heavens to Him Who loved him before, Jesus Christ. And he was established in the Faith, and he became the corner-stone of the Holy Church which belongs to our Lord and our God and our Saviour Jesus Christ to Whom should be sent up glory and honour and praise and adoration and reverence and greatness and dignity with His Good Father and the Holy, Living, Life-giving Spirit now and always and unto the age of the ages and the eternity of eternities. Amen'.

⁽⁶⁾ i.e. 25th September.

Adam (Adam) and of all his posterity, through the intercession of this martyr, the glorious and chosen deacon, the righteous Apostle, the Disciple, in commemoration of whom we are now assembled, to forgive our sins and to pardon our iniquities and to veil our errors, and to grant to us the forgiveness of (our) offences and the veiling of (our) errors and faults, and victory through good deeds before the end of (our) life, and to reduce our prices, and to give increase to our Nile (Nil), and to strengthen our aged and (to grant) chastity to our middle aged people, and a good education to our children, and to soften the hearts of the kings towards you, *and to overcome and to abase all the enemies who oppose us and the Holy Catholic Apostolic Church, and to cause their deceit to return into their throat, and to make us worthy to stand and to enter into it (the Church), and that its door may be open in our face unto the age of the ages and the times, (and) to forgive our sins and establish us in the Orthodox Faith through His great Name until the last breath, through the intercession of the Lady, the Mistress, the Pure Virgin and Mother of God, the Lady of (all) the women of the world, my Lady Mary (Martmaryam), the daughter of Joachim (Yûâkîm), and of our lords, the pure Apostles who closed by their prayers and their teaching the doors of the temples (εῤῥοί), and opened the doors of the Churches, and (through) the prayers of the elect martyrs and of all who have pleased the Lord God by their good deeds* of the offspring of Adam (Adam), until the end of all the ages. Praise and glory and sanctification and worship and greatness and veneration and authority and might and an everlasting and unceasing kingdom (be) to the Holy Trinity, One God, the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit, now and at all times, and unto age of the ages and for ever and ever Amen.

*f. 249 r°

*f. 249 v°

* * *

Completed is the biography of the great martyr and the honoured deacon and the faithful Apostle⁽¹⁾ Stephen (Istāfānūs), (and) it was accomplished on the blessed Thursday, the tenth of the month of Abib the blessed, in the Coptic year 1450 of the Pure Martyrs (= 1734 A.D.) which corresponds to the 13th Safar al-Khair, 1147 of the Lunar (Year). The wretched copyist makes an obeisance (μετανοια) beneath the feet of every one who reads, in it, that he may pray for him for forgiveness and remission, because he is weak and deficient in learning and in deed, and every one who says anything, to him (shall be) the same⁽²⁾.

⁽¹⁾ The title « Apostle » is used here, as in the Didache, not with the meaning of a member of « the Twelve », but merely as an inspired teacher.

⁽²⁾ See this colophon on Plate 2.

العالمة من دريه ادم والي اخر الدهور طه
والتبج والمجد والتقدس والحجود والعظمه
والوقار والسطوان والجبروت والملك
الديانة والرفاه للتالوت المقدس الاله الواحد
الاب والابن والروح القدس الان وكل وان
والى دهر الازهرين مدام الابدين ميام
حسب السعيد العطر والتماسي الكبر والابن
الاماني اشتا فانوش في دوا حبش المارك غانتر
ايب المارك حشيشه فمطبه للتقدس الاله
الموافق ذلك في ١٢ ص ١٧٧ هـ ١٤٧٧
الكلبي يفرح مطانوت تحت اقدامي قري
فيه ان موعود بالما حبه والفرح فانه
عاجز وناقص على وعمل وموقاتي فله ماله

لشمس الالب والابن والروح القدس الاله الواحد
نبتدي بقون الله تعالى وحسن توبته
بفتح شارت العذبي الجميل والانا
الكرام المختار اول الشهدا ورائس الثمنا
الرسول العطر اشتا فانوش تلمذنا
والاهنا وخلصنا يسوع المسيح له المجد الذي
احل صهار في البر والام ليس تهم صوبه
الملك بتمكاته وطوباه فمنا يمين
المجد لله التقديس الابن الاول العريس بطر الان
يا فلق الذي والروح القدس ارحمني الناري
التالوت الكامل الاله الواحد بلا افتراق ولا
اسراج ولا اختلاط الغير في الغير محنوني
الذي هو موق الغوف ويحت القنت الذي له
تلقان النجا والارض ملازلة الغالما للون